

TRAIN WITH **TAKU**



**TANAKA GABAZA**

Pull-up Program

# PROGRAM SUMMARY

Tanaka Gabaza

- Note that this is assuming improving pull-ups is a priority.
- Do the pull ups FIRST THING on your upper body days, then the accessories you can chuck in where you like during your upper body sessions.
- Make sure to separate the 2 upper body sessions by at least 3 days to get adequate rest.
- You can fit in the rest of your training as you like.

# PRINCIPLES

- **2x per week frequency:** If you want to get better at pull ups, do pull ups (Who would've thought, right?). More practice will make you more neurologically efficient at the movement, just from practising it frequently.
- **Variation of grip type:** Slight variation in joint angles helps minimise the chance of weak points arising. It also helps minimise joint overuse.
- **Reverse Pyramid Training:** First set heavy, following sets are lighter. Very simple, very effective at getting stronger in a variety of rep ranges.
- **Relevant assistance movements:** These help strengthen the muscles involved in the pull up. The accessories must be relevant to the “main movement” you want to improve.

# DAY 1

\* “AMRAP” = “As many quality reps as possible”

## 1: Pull ups (Overhand, shoulder-width grip) - 4 sets

Set 1: Bodyweight (AMRAP)

Sets 2 - 4: 3 X 8 -10 with a resistance band assisted. Use less assistance next week if you get 28 total reps across the last 3 sets.

## 2: Rack chins (Overhand Grip) - 2 sets x 8 - 12

Start with bodyweight. If you get 2 x 12, WITH GOOD FORM, next week add load (e.g. on legs or with backpack). 1.25-2.5kg increments.

## 3: Seated Incline Dumbbell Curls - 3 sets AMRAP

Add weight next week if you get 35 total reps across 3 sets

# DAY 2

\* “AMRAP” = “As many quality reps as possible”

## 1: Pull ups (Underhand or Neutral grip) - 4 sets

Set 1: Bodyweight (AMRAP)

Sets 2 - 4: 3 X 8 -10 with a resistance band assisted. Use less assistance next week if you get 28 total reps across the last 3 sets.

## 2: Inverted rows - 3 sets x 8 - 12

Start with bodyweight. If you get 3 x 12, WITH GOOD FORM, next week add load (e.g. on legs or with backpack). 1.25-2.5kg increments.

## 3: Barbell Curls 3 x 8 - 12

Add weight next week if you get 12 reps across all 3 sets

# 3 MEAL IDEAS



**FITNESS FRIENDLY LOADED FRIES**  
**596kcal, 72g carbs, 38g protein, 18g fat**

125g lean mince (raw weight)  
1 teaspoon olive oil  
1 small white potato  
2 small sweet potatoes  
20g grated mozzarella

**Video link:** <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/DJwv8STcpyQ>



**HIGH PROTEIN PIZZA AND SALAD**  
**567kcal, 44g carbs, 62g protein, 15g fat**

2 x seeded wholemeal flatbreads  
200g breast (raw weight) - 1 fillet  
50g tomato sauce (e.g. pasta sauce)  
30g mozzarella  
50g sweet and crunchy salad  
1kcal spray

**Video link:** [https://www.youtube.com/shorts/PYbPGoeoU\\_s](https://www.youtube.com/shorts/PYbPGoeoU_s)



**Prawn “fried” rice and skinless honey  
garlic chicken**  
**652kcal, 43g protein, 64g carbs, 20g  
fat**

**Prawn fried rice:** 75g basmati rice (raw weight), 1 egg (scrambled), 1/2 tablespoon olive oil, 1/2 tablespoon low salt soy sauce, chopped spring onions 1kcal spray, drop of semi-skimmed milk

**Honey garlic chicken marinade:**  
Skinless chicken quarter, 1 teaspoon honey, 1/2 tbsp low salt soy sauce, garlic powder (or fresh garlic), thyme, lemon juice, vinegar, a little bit of aromat.

**Ingredients (to be split into 4 equal portions once cooked):**

300g basmati rice (Weighed raw), 4 tablespoons soy sauce, 4 eggs (scrambled), 2 tablespoons olive oil, 1 chopped spring onions, 2 x 180g (150g drained) packs of lighthouse Bay prawns (you can find them in LIDL - they're already be cooked and ready to eat)

**Cooking:**

**CHICKEN:** Buy a pack of 4/5 chicken leg quarters. Remove skin from the chicken quarters. Add lemon juice and vinegar. Mix the pack of chicken with 4 teaspoons of honey, 2 tablespoons low salt soy sauce. Add garlic powder, thyme, and a little aromat.

**While the chicken is cooking, do what is below.**

**Rice:** Wash and boil the 300g of rice. Boil for 15mins or so. While the rice is boiling, Beat 4 eggs, add a drop of milk. Scramble with 2 tbsp olive oil on medium heat. If it starts to stick, add 1kcal spray.

Optional: Add oregano to the egg. Once the rice is done, mix it with the eggs, and 2 tbsp soy sauce and stir for a 2-3 mins on medium heat. At the end, add in the two packs of prawns (drain them first) and the chopped u spring onion. Leave to simmer for 5mins or so.